

ISRAEL JACOB ORTIZ

Backend Engineer • Java • Spring Boot • Python • Go • Microservices • Kafka • Kubernetes • AWS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 5+ years of professional experience building scalable, reliable microservices and distributed systems in **Java/Spring Boot, Python, and Go**. Deep in REST/gRPC API design, event-driven architecture (Kafka), relational and NoSQL data stores, and high-throughput systems on Kubernetes and AWS with strong reliability practices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Backend Engineer | *SUCCESS Magazine*

Microservices • APIs • Distributed Systems

Apr 2023 – Present

Washington, DC (Hybrid)

- **Design and build microservices** in Java/Spring Boot and Go for a platform serving millions of users, cutting p95 latency by about 35% with caching, indexing, and async processing.
- **Build event-driven pipelines** with Kafka and gRPC for high-throughput data flows, with idempotency, retries, and clean service boundaries.
- **Own reliability and performance** — SLOs, observability, JVM profiling, and query tuning that keep services at 99.9%+ uptime — and mentor engineers through design and code review.

Founder & Principal Engineer | *Ambrose*

Boutique Backend Consultancy • Part-Time

Jul 2021 – Present

Remote

- **Founded and run Ambrose**, a boutique backend consultancy, leading a small team that delivers Spring Boot and Python REST/gRPC APIs over PostgreSQL and MongoDB on AWS/Kubernetes for SMB and enterprise clients.

Backend Engineer / Team Lead | *SPCA International*

Services & Data — Team Lead

Sep 2020 – Mar 2023

Washington, DC

- **Led a four-engineer team** over two and a half years, owning Java/Spring services and PostgreSQL and shipping nine releases.
- **Migrated a monolith to services** on AWS, cutting response times from over a second to roughly 300ms and improving scalability.

Freelance Backend Engineer | *Independent / Contract*

Solo Client Work Prior to Founding Ambrose

Feb 2019 – Jun 2021

Remote

- **Built Spring Boot and Python APIs** for early clients as an independent contractor — building the track record that led to founding Ambrose.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Java 17, Spring Boot, Python (FastAPI, Django), Go, SQL; Hibernate/JPA, OOD & design patterns

APIs & Messaging: REST, gRPC, GraphQL, OpenAPI; Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ; event-driven & microservices architecture

Data & Caching: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch; schema design, indexing, query optimization

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (ECS, EKS, Lambda, RDS), Docker, Kubernetes; CI/CD, Terraform; observability, SLOs, JUnit/pytest

EDUCATION

Virginia Tech — *M.Eng., Computer Science (Backend & Distributed Systems)*

2023 – 2024

GPA: 4.0 | Full-Ride & Tech Talent Investment Program (TTIP) Scholar

Relevant coursework: Distributed Systems, Microservices Architecture, API Design (REST/gRPC), Databases & Query Optimization, Concurrency, Cloud & Kubernetes, Message Queues.

University of Mary Washington — *B.S., Computer Science & Economics (Double Major)*

2019 – 2022

GPA: 3.8 | Dean's List 7/8 Semesters

Honors & Leadership: FBLA Collegiate Chapter — President & Founder; University-Wide Backend & Systems Design Competition — 1st Place; IT Advisory Board — Treasurer.

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate • Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) • Oracle Certified Professional: Java SE 17 • Confluent Certified Developer for Apache Kafka